the movements of free men there, he remembered his home', which was a 'home, where his countrymen were rotting and from which he had just left'.[14] After he was hauled up before the courts for trial, 'he gave two great statements in the court' and 'in those, he very bravely and courageously admitted to everything' because Kartar Singh was a brave man and he did not know how to die like a coward'.[15] This was, of course, exactly the manner in which Bhagat Singh too went to his death.

Another formative event in Bhagat Singh's life was the Amritsar Massacre of 1919, which stands as the leading example of colonial coercive technique in India. Its memories were brought alive again most vividly when in 2019 the tercentenary was commemorated. A flurry of books, articles and programmes were devoted to its remembrance, with world leaders adding their voice of regret to its occurrence a hundred years ago. The name of Udham Singh appeared in Western literature for the first time. He was the man who plotted over a number of years to kill Michael O'Dwyer, the lieutenant-governor of Punjab, held chiefly responsible for the massacre. What few would have come to realize is the importance of another Indian hero, one by the name of Bhagat Singh, in the influence he had on Udham Singh, who had avenged the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre. His fame has been such that he has been popularly known as 'Shaheed-i-Azam Sardar Udham Singh'. It was he who, as Anita Anand has memorably described in her recent book, shot O'Dwyer in London in March 1940, twenty years after the 1919 massacre, holding him responsible for the repressive measures which culminated in the Amritsar Massacre. Udham Singh insisted on describing himself as 'Mohammad Singh Azad' while in custody awaiting the hangman's noose, because when he shot to kill O'Dwyer as he moved to the Speaking Platform in Caxton Hall, where a joint meeting of the East India Association and the Central Asian Society had been convened, he did so on behalf of those who had died as Hindus, Muslims and Sikhs on that balmy April evening in 1919 in Amritsar. Udham Singh was tried for the murder at the Central Criminal Court on 4 and 5 June 1940 before Justice Atkinson.